



## MONTHLY UPDATE

# Senegal: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-05 • 36 systems and instruments tracked

*Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.*

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH • GOVERNANCE • FINANCE • ICT INFRASTRUCTURE • DPI • DIGITALISATION • TECHNOLOGY  
• CAPACITY • INCLUSION • DATA • GEOPOLITICS

## Summary of the month

A law was passed and the systems it protects were breached in the same week. The National Assembly [adopted the critical-infrastructure protection bill unanimously on 20 August](#), which [provides for a national computer emergency response team the country does not yet have](#), and the Prime Minister [announced parliamentary hearings after recent attacks on state systems](#). Recorded offences barely moved: [3,794 cybercrime offences in 2025 against 3,902 in 2024](#).

Civil registration is the busiest part of the record and the least funded. Remediation of the registry digitisation system [ran at Kaolack from 10 to 20 August](#), the agency [gave its software-deployment figure at African Civil Registration Day](#), and its director-general [stated that the agency's 2026 appropriation has still not been notified](#). On the other side of the ledger, the National Assembly [voted 129-0 to open a commission of inquiry into about 48 billion FCFA committed since 2017 under the student-computer programme](#).

## Governance

### Strategies, plans and policies

The body meant to steer digital governance has not started. The digital governance steering committee, [created in March 2026, was still stated five months later to be operational in the near future](#). A coordinating body that has not convened is what sits behind the strategies this section otherwise records as adopted but unreadable.

### Legislation and regulation

The critical-infrastructure framework that was undated at the end of July reached parliament a fortnight later. A bill on protecting critical information infrastructure and digital security [was presented to the National Assembly's intercommission on 13 August and examined by its committees](#), proposing a national cybersecurity authority, national and sectoral computer emergency response teams, and obligations on critical operators graded by risk, alongside [local hosting of public data, service continuity and personal-data protection](#) under the state's technology-deal agenda. Four days later the ministry published its own account of the contents: obligations [graded by risk, with ordinary networks on standard requirements and critical infrastructure on enhanced ones](#) — monitoring, data backup, encryption of sensitive information, business continuity and disaster recovery, and regular resilience testing — and a National Cybersecurity Authority, a national response team, sectoral teams and cybersecurity operations [services](#), with an industrial objective attached: the ministry expects the compliance requirement itself to create accredited service providers, domestic firms and skilled jobs. It cleared on 20 August: the National Assembly

adopted law n° 25/2026 unanimously, mandating in-country storage of state-sensitive data, empowering the National Cybersecurity Authority and folding in technology-neutral standards for the AI era and the child-online-protection plan, seven days after it reached the intercommission. In the same debate the Assembly's first vice-president argued cybersecurity has to become a standing administrative culture, calling for mandatory staff training, professional-only communication channels and minimum device-security standards - a description of where the state's own practice stands rather than of what the law requires. Every provision is still the ministry's description; the text is not held, no promulgation date or gazette reference is published, and nothing the law creates exists yet.

## Data protection

The data protection commission published its quarterly opinion for April to June 2026: 195 files handled, 154 declarations and 41 authorisation requests, producing 153 declaration receipts and 39 authorisations, with one processing operation rejected, two data controllers heard, eight complaints received and one report. It is the first published measure of the commission's own throughput this ledger holds. It counts registrations rather than enforcement, and the commission still operates under a law unamended since 2008.

## Regional collaboration

Regionally, Senegal became one of 29 founding states of an intergovernmental AI-governance body on 16 July, and joined the approval on 31 July of three ECOWAS statistical methodological guides.

The bilateral channel moved from signature to work. The June 2026 telecommunications and digital-economy memorandum with the Gambia went into implementation around four priorities — connectivity, cybersecurity, skills and digital transformation — with the telecommunications and digital minister travelling to Banjul to agree the first joint work, and the two regulators separately deepening cooperation on frequency coordination, service quality and cross-border roaming. What Senegal supplies in that relationship is transit: the Gambia's terrestrial fibre build is limited and it depends largely on a single submarine cable for international access, with only limited terrestrial redundancy through Senegal. No work programme, budget or timetable is published. That work took its first steering-committee session at Banjul on 29 August 2026, where the four priorities were settled as infrastructure and interoperability, cyber resilience, capacity building and regulatory harmonisation, with rural electronic-government access named among them. No timetable, budget or named deliverable is attached to any of the four.

## Standards

Senegal adopted non-binding Francophone West African AI governance guidelines on 6 July.

Senegal held its first national green-coding and responsible-digital workshop, bringing about 170 people from the sector to Dakar on 18 and 19 August 2026 to set the basis for a national approach to digital sobriety. Nothing was adopted at it.

## Finance

### Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

The constraint on that deployment is money, and the agency said so itself. On 17 August its director-general said the agency's 2026 budget had still not been notified, and named that as what is holding back the pace of the Kaolack phase — the deployment of the civil-status software and activation of the citizen request platform across Nioro, Ndiedieng and Kaolack between 10 and 20 August. The base holds no appropriation figure for the agency for 2026, which is recorded as a gap.

## ICT Infrastructure

### Technical Capacity

A continental count puts [seven data centres in Senegal at mid-2025, level with Ghana, against South Africa's 56, Kenya's 19 and Nigeria's 17](#). It is a reference figure, cited and not absorbed: the base holds no Senegalese primary count and no capacity figure at all.

### Cybersecurity

The institutions arrived after the attacks. The critical-infrastructure bill [provides for a national computer emergency response team the country does not yet have](#), and the Prime Minister [announced parliamentary hearings following recent attacks on state systems](#); no system, breach count or data loss is named in the announcement.

Procurement is the state's own diagnosis of the blockage, and it moved by memorandum: [a foreign cybersecurity supplier is reported seeking Senegalese partners](#), with no contract, value or scope stated. The offence figures the case for all this rests on moved barely at all: national police recorded [3,794 cybercrime offences in 2025 against 3,902 in 2024](#), reported alongside an international police organisation's estimate of at least US\$5bn in Africa-wide losses over the same year. Neither the recording basis nor a clear-up rate is stated.

## DPI

### Data Exchange

A government enterprise-architecture account of 3 August records [platforms still siloed sixteen months after the interoperability platform launched](#), with the architecture to be fed by a full inventory of national digital systems. Four narrower exchanges moved in the same weeks: [a workshop on 23 July to diagnose social-protection systems](#), the minister stating each structure runs its own system and cannot share data; [a climate-transparency data project launched on 22 July over 42 months](#); [a three-month customs roadmap with Gambia](#); and [a convention to interconnect the digital agency and the health-cover platform](#), whose personal-data commitment was not referred to the regulator.

### Digital Identity and CRVS

Consolidated agency data at 17 July records [437 of 629 civil-status centres fully deployed, 112 of them running the citizen-facing service](#); on 13 July the agency reported [15.3m records loaded](#).

Deployment moved again in August, and the agency put a frame around it. At African Civil Registration Day in Kaolack on 10 August it [launched phase four of its remediation plan and put deployment at 74% of centres, up from 70% five days earlier, with the citizen request platform live in 189 communes](#), phase four extending to Kaffrine and Tambacounda; its director-general described civil registration as an instrument of sovereignty.

### Digital Payments and Fintech

The country leads its monetary union on electronic money, on figures that also show how little of the union's account base is alive. It [held 29.7 per cent of union electronic-money outstandings and 26.5 per cent of large microfinance assets at the end of 2025, hosting 81 large institutions and 2.28 million of the union's 14.66 million accounts](#); union-wide, [electronic-money outstandings rose 35.2 per cent to CFAF 1,923.2 billion and accounts reached 172.9 million, of which only 60.6 million were active](#). The domestic market is a duopoly, [one provider on close to 80 per cent of outstandings against the other's 19 per cent](#).

## Registries

On 28 July an audit mission [launched across 74 communes, 59 already audited and fifteen selected on risk analysis](#); no findings are stated. On 30 July the mines ministry and the deposits fund [signed a convention commissioning professional cards and a nationwide database of artisanal gold miners](#), with no enrolment target, host or data-protection provision reported.

The digitisation the audit is measuring has its own figures. The civil-status agency [puts 471 of 629 centres digitised, 43% activation of the citizen portal and 15,352,830 records centralised on pilot data at 13 July](#), with a remediation push at Kaolack from 10 to 20 August before extending to Kaffrine and Tambacounda. The figures are the agency's own and no national completion date is stated; the gap between three quarters of centres digitised and two in five citizens activating the portal is the one the remediation is aimed at.

## Sectoral management information systems

The higher-education, research and innovation ministry [reported a further step in the digital transformation of its services](#), framed around interoperability; no service list, user count or completion date is given.

## Other GovTech and e-Gov

The month's clearest movement is a removal rather than an addition. The tax authority [withdrew the paper fiscal stamp on 20 July, making the digital service the sole recognised channel nationwide](#), with QR-coded stamps bought and received remotely. Unused paper stamps were exchangeable until 15 August and no offline or assisted route is stated. Eight days later the [free electronic stamp service was suspended by its provider, citing an administrative decision outside its control, with refunds promised within 72 hours and users stating they now pay additional fees for an identical service](#) — the first consumer-cost consequence of state-platform exclusivity the base holds, and it is not stated whether the decision was addressed to that provider or to the distribution channel generally. Separately the state procurement platform is [operating and named by the procurement regulator as intended to capture the procedures of a thousand administrations](#), with its protection a stated priority alongside critical state digital infrastructure; no count of administrations onboarded, procurement volume, availability record or security accreditation is given.

Parliament's own systems entered the record for the first time, and only as a purchase order: on 5 August the United Nations development programme [opened a tender to supply IT equipment for the National Assembly's SIPOP system](#). What that system does, what it costs and when it runs are all absent from the notice, which is the whole of what the base holds on it.

## Digitalisation

### Rural digital data capture

The head of the deconcentrated service network said the thing his own network runs on is missing. Closing a tour of four regions, he [said that without connectivity there can be no deconcentration of public services, and listed connectivity, workstations, IT equipment, archive and mail management and communications security among the problems found in prefectures and gendarmerie posts](#), while announcing the forthcoming integration of civil registration into the national dematerialisation platform. No centre count, connectivity rate or remediation budget is published against the diagnosis.

## Technology

### AI

A national prize ceremony on 30 July presented a [Wolof and French AI tutor reachable by ordinary phone call with no internet, its curriculum validated by school inspectors and hosted on servers in Senegal](#). No user, pricing or evaluation figure is given, and the education ministry's role is asserted by the vendor rather than confirmed by it. The same readiness assessment records an [ethics committee as planned](#), with no statute, membership or chair. The state's own AI build was presented abroad rather than at home: the Senegal AI Factory was [set out to an international AI-process meeting in Tokyo as the main component of the Senegal Digital Factory under the technology strategy's eighth priority programme, covering national AI capability, startups, applied research and training](#), with no launch date, budget, compute location or partner commitment stated.

What none of it runs under is a statute. A four-country comparative study presented on 10 August [found no AI-specific legislation in force or in draft in Senegal](#), leaving the strategy stack and an ethics committee that is still only planned to carry the field between them.

### ICT Industry

A French insurance-technology company [acquired Tanel, a Senegalese health-technology firm, in what the account calls a rare francophone health-technology exit](#). No price, range or cash-and-stock split was disclosed by either side and the company's revenue was withheld, so nothing here can be put against the sector's other exits. What the transaction does establish is a buyer outside the region taking a Senegalese health platform, which is the first such disposal on this ledger.

## Capacity

### Literacy

Connectivity is being aimed at classrooms. The education ministry [plans to connect more than 8,000 primary schools to the internet through Starlink](#). Satellite is the route because terrestrial reach is the constraint, and a plan of that size would change what the Digital Schools programme can assume. Nothing in the record held names a school connected, a cost or a funding source.

### Training and skills

Two facts about the state's own capacity arrived in the same week and point opposite ways. The national statistics agency [graduated 60 statisticians - 33 statistician-economists and 27 statistician-analysts, drawn from ten African countries - taking its school's cumulative output past 900 since 2011](#), and used the ceremony to press ministries to recruit them into sectoral statistical services: an absorption problem stated rather than measured, since no figure is published for how many of the 900 work in Senegalese public statistics. Against it, the National Assembly [voted 129-0 to open a commission of inquiry into about 48 billion FCFA committed since 2017 under the student-computer programme, over alleged procurement breaches and 800 defective machines stored unused at the country's largest university](#). The programme has run for nine years and publishes no delivery total, unit cost or student-reach figure, so the inquiry's envelope is the only quantity the record holds about it.

## Inclusion

### Access to services

The flagship access programme is under investigation. The National Assembly [voted 129-0 to open a commission of inquiry into about 48 billion FCFA committed since 2017 under the student-computer programme, over alleged procurement breaches and 800 defective machines stored unused at the country's largest university](#). Nine years in, the programme publishes no delivery total, unit cost or student-reach figure, so the inquiry's envelope is the only quantity the record holds about it.

### Digital divides

The month's one inclusion measure came from the despatch box rather than a survey. Debating the critical-infrastructure bill, the telecommunications minister [told parliament that 40% of Senegalese still have no access to connectivity](#), citing a 2024 sector diagnosis of coverage gaps and unmet operator obligations. The diagnosis itself is not held, no definition of access accompanies the figure, and it is two years old at the point of its citation.

## Data

### National statistics

An outside assessment put the statistical system at two speeds. An International Monetary Fund report [found macroeconomic statistics generally reliable while sector-specific statistical agencies are constrained by staffing and finance, and recommended a clearer coordination mandate for the statistics agency through a permanent inter-agency committee reconciling national accounts, public finance, debt, monetary and external-sector figures before publication](#), alongside broader public-debt reporting and steps toward the enhanced dissemination standard. The authorities accepted the recommendations under the 2024-2028 statistical strategy; nothing dated is published against any of them.

## Geopolitics

### US / hyperscaler activities

The digital minister pitched the technology strategy in Washington, holding [working sessions on financing mechanisms for digital infrastructure, data centres, digital identity and payment systems](#). No financier, amount or instrument was reported.

### China activities

The sovereign cloud is [in testing, with data-centre infrastructure deployed and verified for redundancy and reliability to host sensitive national data on Senegalese territory](#), accelerated ahead of an international sporting event. No contract, value, hosting term, exit arrangement or data-access terms are reported — a sovereignty claim resting on a vendor relationship whose terms are not held.

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